Hostinger marketing & product analytics: profitable channels, product adoption and experiments

OVERVIEW

Independent case study for Hostinger's Marketing and Product Data Analyst roles: seven questions for the Affiliates, Influencers, PPC, SEO, Product Marketing and product teams (Reach, Mail, referral programme), worked end to end with SQL (DuckDB), Python and Power BI on SIMULATED data calibrated on hostinger.com.

SIMULATED · PAGES 2-3

17% → 8%

of sales credited to coupon sites by last click vs data-driven attribution; 56% of their buyers already had a cart

SIMULATED · PAGE 3

+37%

more creator sales than links and codes show (brand searches after videos); 4,226 code uses came from leaks

SIMULATED · PAGE 4

€104 vs €76

net value of an SEO customer vs a PPC non-brand customer after 24 months (refunds and renewals included)

SIMULATED · PAGE 5

14%

of brand-ad clicks are incremental: 86% come back through the organic result when ads are off (geo test)

Business questions

marketing & product analytics

1 · Efficiency What does a customer cost per channel, and which channel pays back?
2 · Attribution What changes when the attribution model changes?
3 · Partners Which creators and affiliates are really worth their price?
4 · Quality Do the customers of each channel stay and renew?
5 · Budget Does spend create sales, and where should the next euro go?
6 · Adoption Where do new Reach users drop out, and what is a successful adoption? (pages 6-7)
7 · Experiments Does the AI-prefilled campaign work, and is the referral reward worth it? (pages 8-9)

Marketing: steer budget on 12-month net value and incrementality, not last-click orders. Trim PPC non-brand by 20%, stop paying coupon commission when the cart was already started, move the €305k to creators (+2,144 orders a year at the same budget).
Product: fix the contacts-import step, ship the AI-prefilled first campaign with a holdout, block self-referrals before touching the reward rate.

Data & methods

SIMULATED 30 months, 6 countries, 1.3M visitors, 2.6M touchpoints, 129,431 orders; for the same customers 2.3M product events (Amplitude format), 45,778 Reach users, one A/B test, 3,620 referrals (Python, seed 42). Not Hostinger data.
PUBLIC Hostinger prices, 30-day money-back guarantee, affiliate terms (10 Nov 2026); Reach plans and referral terms (13 Nov 2026).
SQL paths, 5 attribution models, censoring-safe customer value and retention, ordered funnels, test checks (window functions).
Python Markov, geo-test and rollout difference-in-differences, A/B test (power, sample-ratio check, z-test, bootstrap), scenarios.
Power BI star schema shared by both parts, 77 DAX measures, an attribution-model switch.
AI AI-assisted workflow: I used Claude, mainly to write scripts faster. I drove the project: I defined the questions, chose and validated the data sources, made the analytical decisions and checked every result.

Hostinger context

public facts used to calibrate the simulation, hostinger.com

Customers 5M+ in 150+ countries. **Plans** paid upfront; Premium $1.99/mo for 48 months, renews at $10.99/mo. **Refunds** 30-day money-back guarantee. **Affiliates** from 40% commission, 30-day cookie, none on 1-month plans or renewals.
Reach AI e-mail marketing, Starter plan up to 100 recipients. **Mail** business e-mail with AI replies. **Referrals** referrer earns 20% of the friend's purchase, the friend gets 20% off, reward paid after 45 days.
How to read titles state the conclusion · SIMULATED marks generated data · dashed lines mark a threshold · SQL, notebooks and Power BI project in the repository.

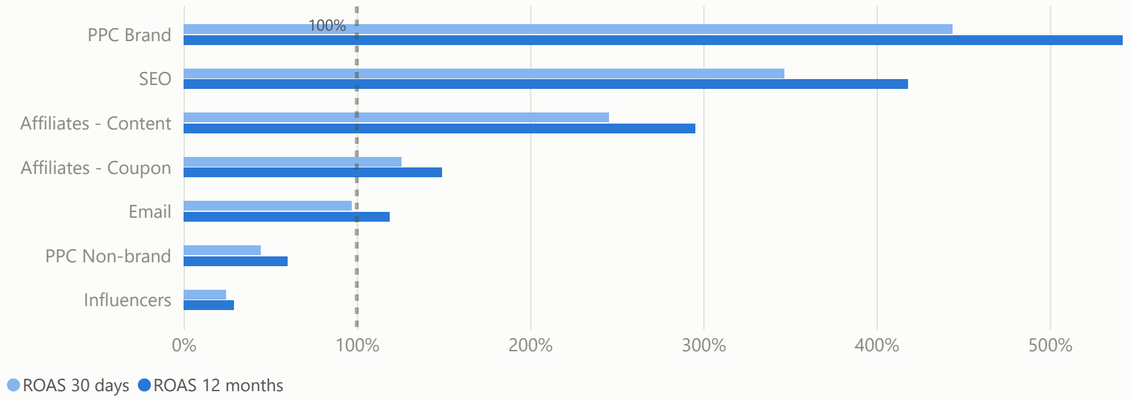
Half the budget goes to PPC non-brand, which returns €0.60 per euro within 12 months

SIMULATED DATA

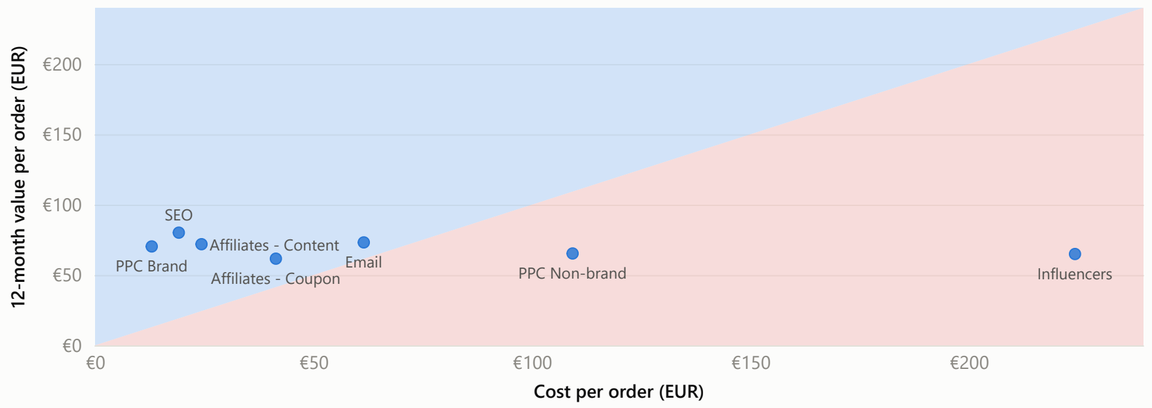
Under data-driven attribution PPC non-brand takes 51% of spend at €109 per order and does not pay back within a year; SEO returns €4.2. Value = first payment net of refunds (Hostinger's 30-day guarantee) plus renewals, expected at 12 months. Change the attribution model (top right) to see how the ranking moves.

Marketing spend, 30 months	Orders	Blended cost per order	Blended 12-month ROAS	Attribution model
€5M	129K	€39	185%	Markov (data-driven)

ROAS by channel at 30 days and 12 months (dashed = break-even)



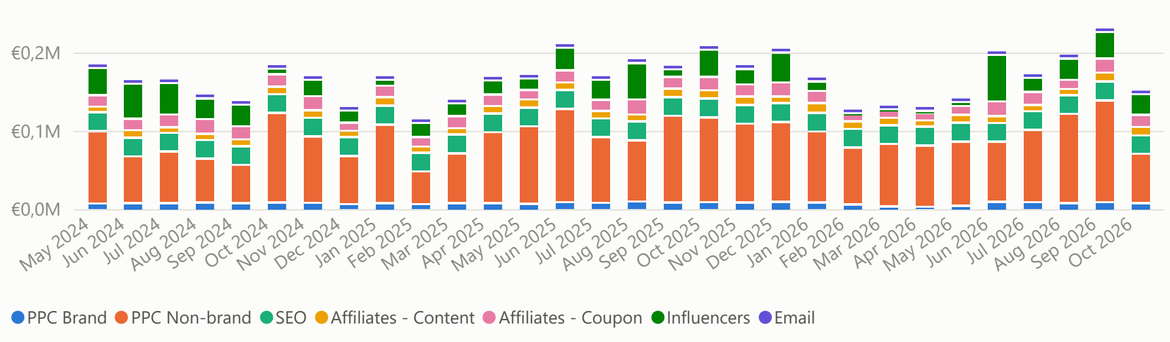
Cost per order vs 12-month value per order, EUR (red = costs more than it brings in)



Channel scorecard under the selected model (red = below break-even)

Channel	Spend	Spend Share	Orders	CAC	Value / order 12m	ROAS 12m
PPC Non-brand	€2 557 748	51%	23 398	€109	€65	60%
SEO	€720 003	14%	37 551	€19	€80	418%
Influencers	€684 348	14%	3 051	€224	€65	29%
Affiliates - Coupon	€444 803	9%	10 745	€41	€62	149%
Affiliates - Content	€278 100	6%	11 412	€24	€72	295%
PPC Brand	€183 272	4%	14 122	€13	€70	542%
Email	€179 996	4%	2 926	€62	€73	119%

Spend by month and channel, EUR (affiliate and CPA creator fees follow sales)

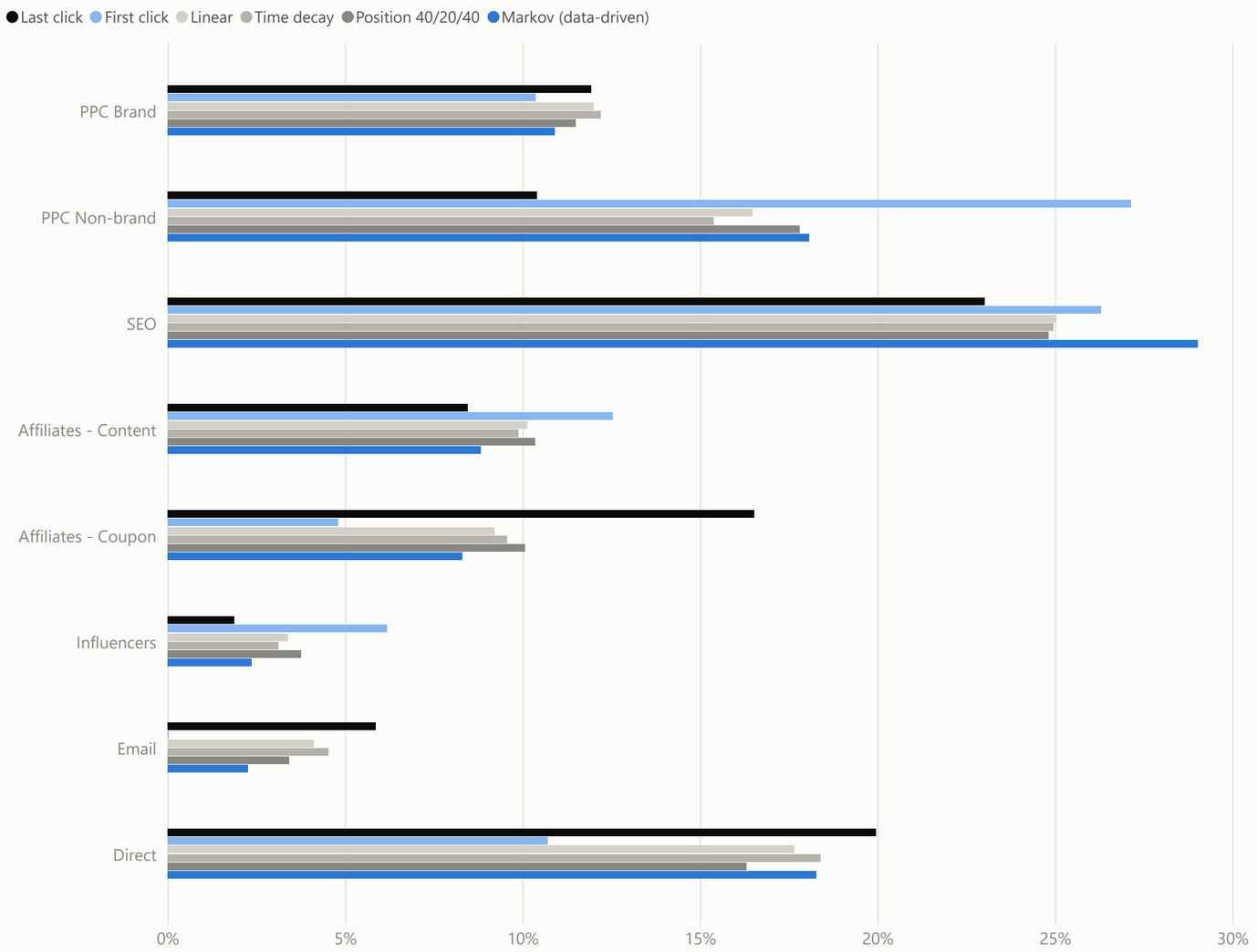


Last click gives coupon sites 17% of sales; data-driven attribution halves it

SIMULATED DATA

Same 129,431 orders, six ways to split the credit. Coupon sites and direct visits sit at the end of journeys, so last click flatters them; PPC non-brand and SEO start journeys. No click model sees a video that was watched but not clicked: influencers get 2-6% of credit under every model (page 3 measures them another way).

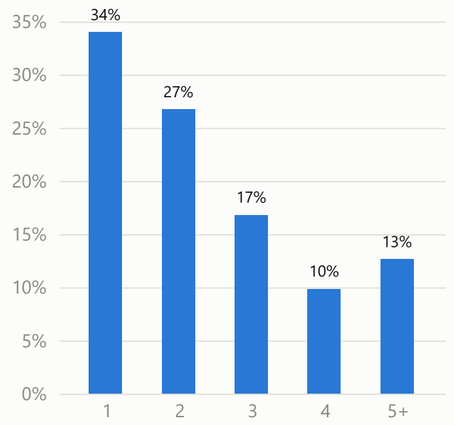
Share of orders credited to each channel, by attribution model



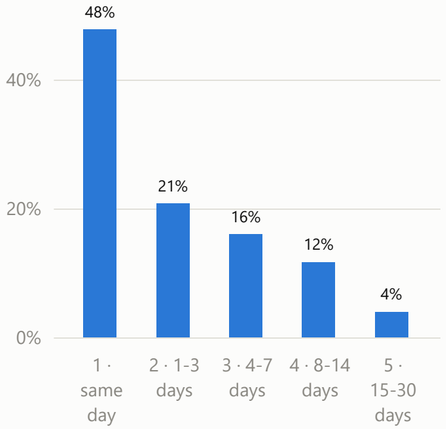
Most frequent conversion paths (30-day window, repeats collapsed)

#	Path	Orders	Share	Days to buy
1	SEO	14 849	11,7%	0,7
2	PPC Non-brand	12 703	10,0%	0,1
3	Affiliates - Content	6 270	4,9%	0,2
4	Direct	5 922	4,7%	0,8
5	PPC Brand	4 829	3,8%	0,4
6	SEO > Direct	3 671	2,9%	3,6
7	Affiliates - Coupon	2 616	2,1%	0,2
8	PPC Non-brand > Direct	2 572	2,0%	3,0
9	Influencers	2 421	1,9%	0,0
10	PPC Non-brand > SEO	2 324	1,8%	3,1
11	SEO > Affiliates - Coupon	2 315	1,8%	1,3
12	PPC Non-brand > Affiliates - Coupon	1 936	1,5%	0,8

Touchpoints before buying (share of orders)



Time from first touch to purchase



SIMULATED data (seed 42), calibrated on public hostinger.com prices, refund and affiliate terms (data/SOURCES.md) - not Hostinger data · Markov = removal effect on 1.3M journeys (buyers and non-buyers) · Independent case study for Hostinger's Marketing and Product Data Analyst roles · Not affiliated with Hostinger, no Hostinger data

Creators drive 37% more sales than links and codes show, but 3 leaked codes inflate their numbers

SIMULATED DATA

Brand searches rise 43% in the 2 weeks after a video. 4,226 creator-code orders (24%) came through coupon sites with no recent video: leaked codes, paid twice (Hostinger's 40%+ affiliate commission + creator fee). On coupon sites, 56% of buyers had already started a cart.

Creator fees, 30 months

€684K

Orders by link or genuine code

15K

Code orders from leaks

4 226

Coupon-site buyers with a cart already started

56%

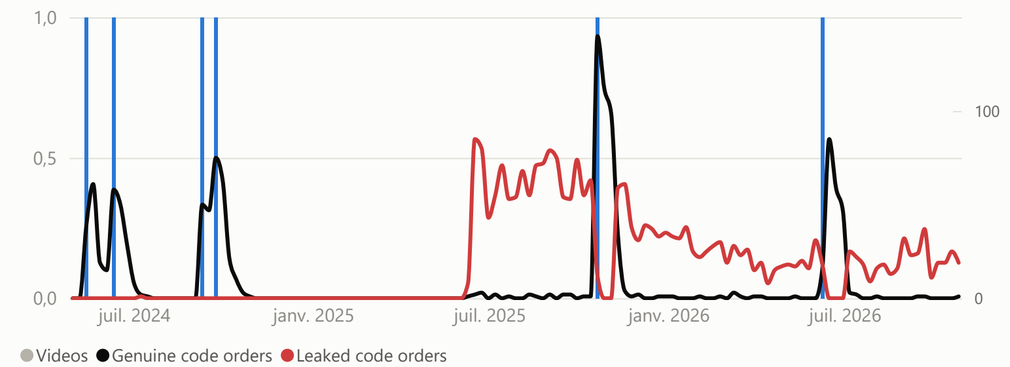
Creator scorecard (red = leaked codes / negative 12-month ROI)

Creator	Platform	Fee	Videos	Cost	Link orders	Code orders	Leaked	Refunds	Cost / genuine order	ROI 12m
CR17	YouTube	flat	9	€47 070	201	1 161	1%	9,8%	€38	21%
CR02	YouTube	flat	6	€44 340	149	3 574	67%	11,1%	€35	40%
CR33	YouTube	flat	7	€40 880	88	521	0%	9,4%	€73	-31%
CR07	TikTok	flat	5	€39 450	38	231	2%	7,8%	€164	-53%
CR23	Instagram	flat	7	€36 470	51	275	1%	9,4%	€121	-38%
CR09	YouTube	flat	7	€33 880	82	434	0%	11,7%	€72	0%
CR11	YouTube	hybrid	3	€32 424	151	1 915	59%	10,1%	€38	100%
CR21	TikTok	flat	8	€31 040	89	480	1%	8,7%	€59	-15%
CR18	YouTube	CPA	5	€29 525	92	1 141	55%	10,6%	€53	-12%
CR08	TikTok	flat	4	€28 600	45	311	1%	11,0%	€89	-21%
CR29	YouTube	flat	9	€26 100	61	288	0%	7,4%	€82	6%
CR26	YouTube	flat	7	€22 750	31	199	1%	10,1%	€107	-35%

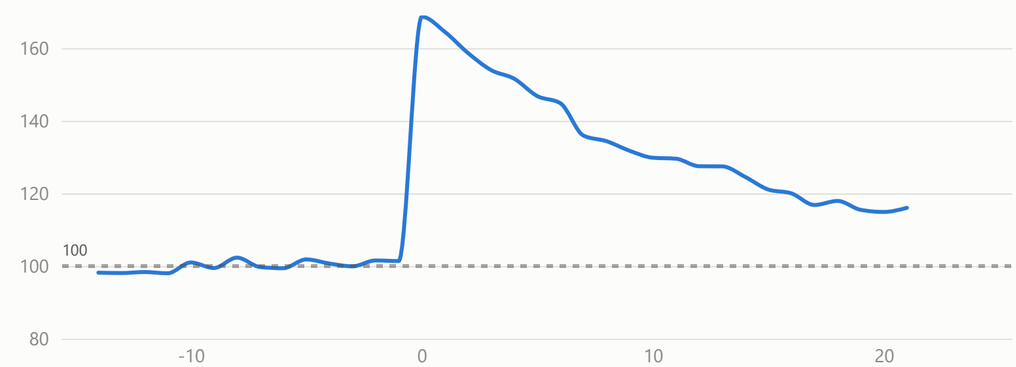
Affiliates by type (orders where the affiliate is the last click = what commission is paid on)

Type	Orders	Commission	Refunds	Cart already started
coupon	21 394	€444 803	12,0%	56%
content	7 671	€190 822	6,7%	0%
review	3 257	€87 277	6,1%	0%

CR02: weekly genuine code uses (black) and leaked uses (red); columns = videos published



Brand searches around a sponsored video, in the creator's country (100 = 2 weeks before; day 0 = video)



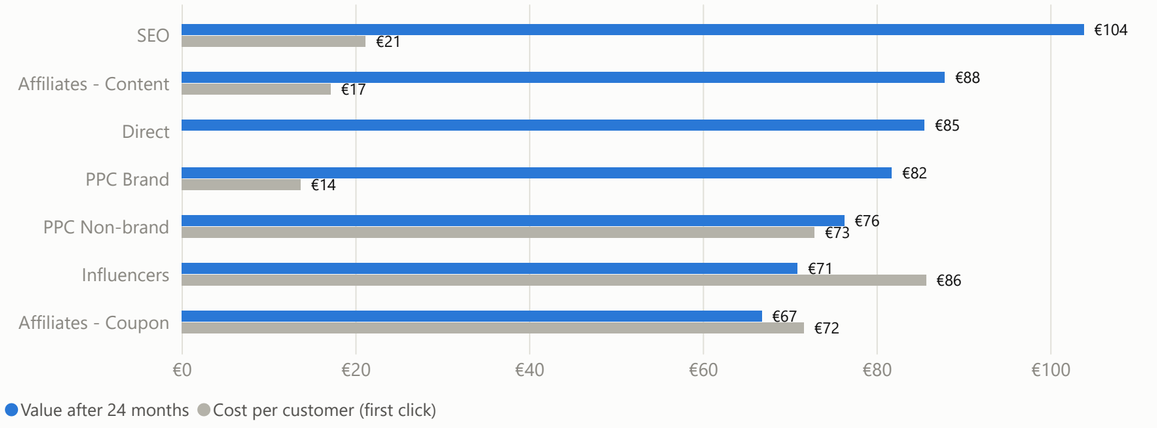
SIMULATED data (seed 42), calibrated on public hostinger.com prices, refund and affiliate terms (data/SOURCES.md) - not Hostinger data · Leak = creator code used after a coupon-site click with no video in the previous 21 days · Independent case study for Hostinger's Marketing and Product Data Analyst roles · Not affiliated with Hostinger, no Hostinger data

An SEO customer is worth €104 after 24 months, a PPC non-brand customer €76

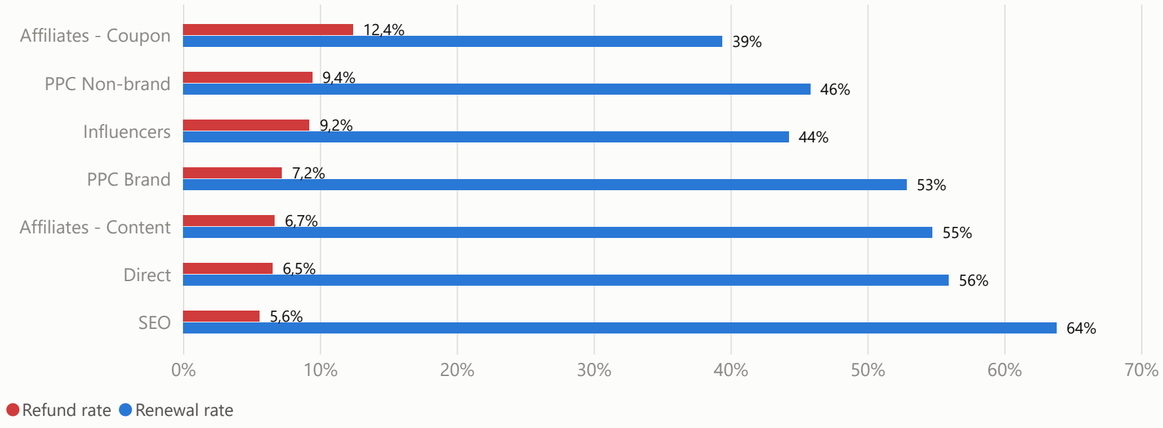
SIMULATED DATA

Hostinger plans are prepaid at an intro price and renew higher, with a 30-day money-back guarantee, so refunds, plan length and renewals drive value. PPC non-brand buyers refund 9% and choose a 1-month plan 18% of the time; SEO buyers refund 6% and renew 64%. By first-click channel; a cohort counts at month k only once k months have passed.

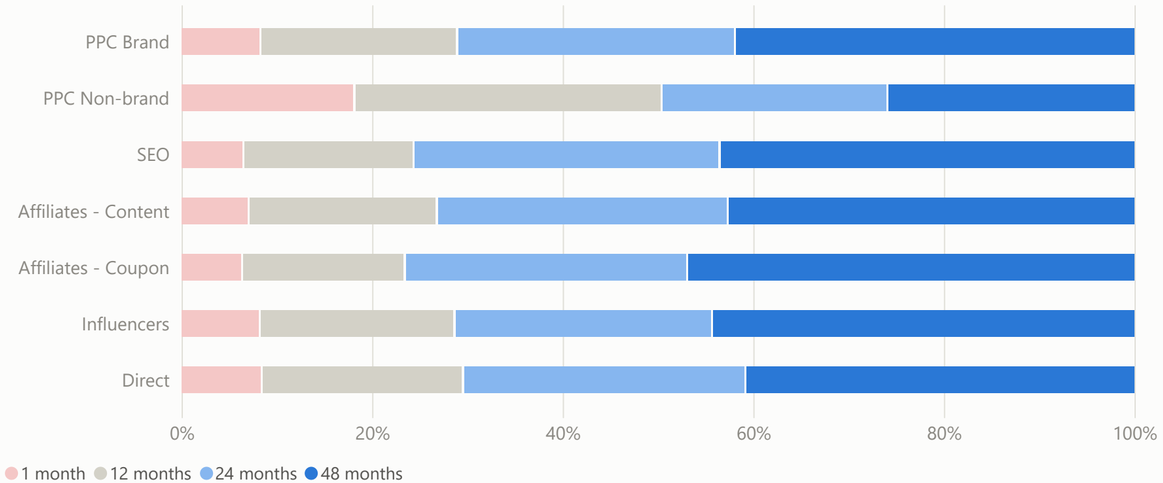
24-month net value per customer (blue) vs acquisition cost (grey), EUR



Refunded within 30 days (red) and renewed at the end of the term (blue)



Plan length chosen at purchase (1 / 12 / 24 / 48 months)



Cumulative net value per customer, EUR, by months since purchase

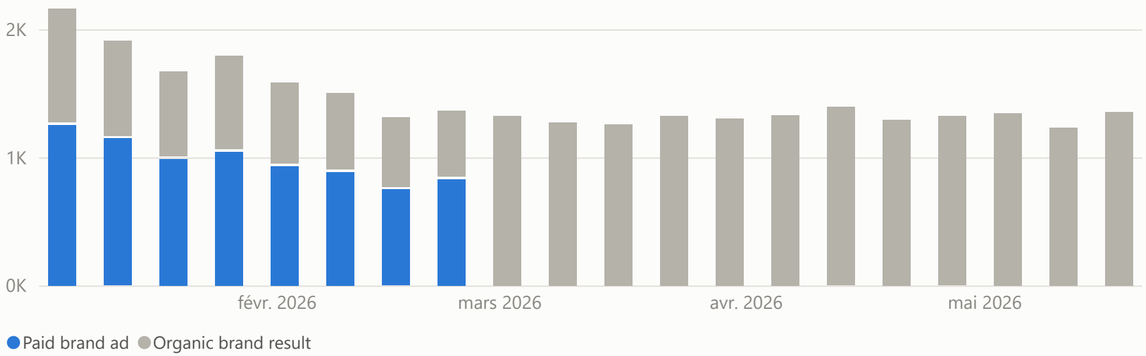
Channel	0	3	6	9	12	15	18	21	24
Affiliates - Content	€60	€61	€61	€61	€72	€72	€71	€71	€88
Affiliates - Coupon	€54	€55	€55	€55	€61	€61	€61	€58	€67
Direct	€59	€60	€60	€60	€71	€71	€70	€70	€85
Influencers	€53	€55	€54	€55	€63	€62	€62	€62	€71
PPC Brand	€57	€59	€59	€59	€70	€70	€70	€69	€82
PPC Non-brand	€48	€50	€51	€51	€66	€65	€65	€66	€76
SEO	€71	€72	€72	€73	€85	€85	€85	€85	€104

Brand ads are only 14% incremental; moving €305k to creators adds +2,144 orders a year

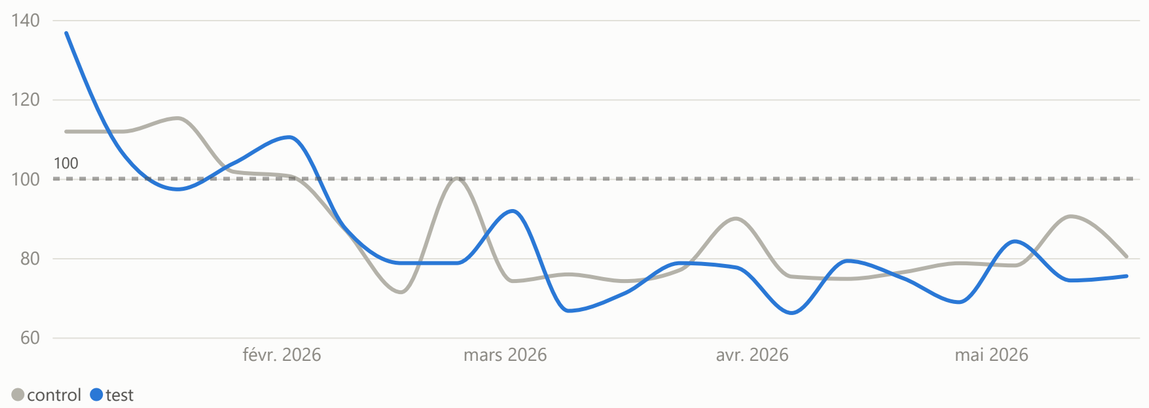
SIMULATED DATA

Geo test: search ads on 'hostinger' paused for 12 weeks in US, ES and ID. 86% of ad clicks came back through the organic brand result (95% CI 77%-95%). At the margin a PPC non-brand order costs €165, a creator order €67.

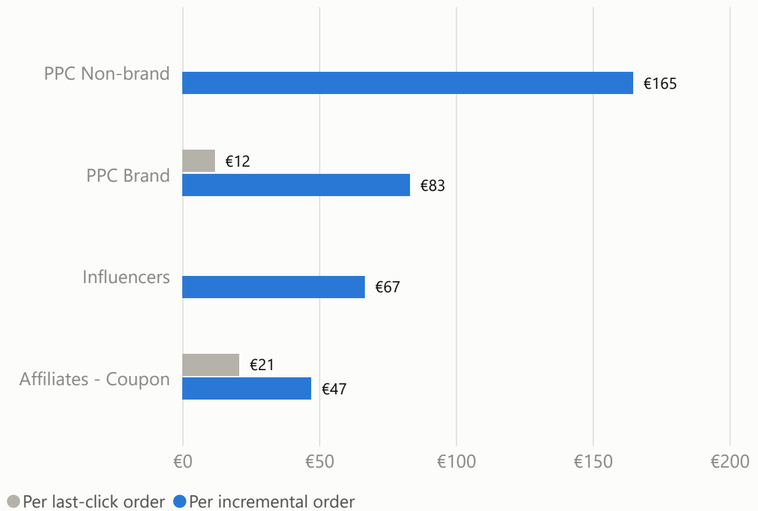
Test countries: weekly brand-search clicks, paid ad (blue) vs organic result (grey). Ads off from 2 March



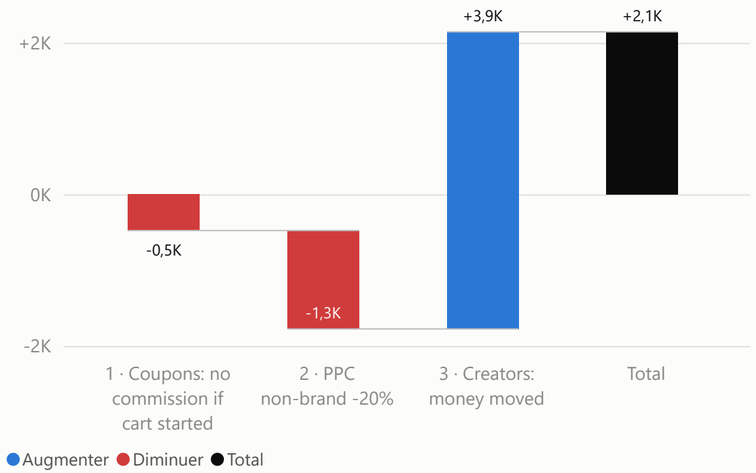
Brand-search orders, index 100 = 8 weeks before the test: test (blue) vs control (grey)



Cost per order as reported (grey) vs per incremental order (blue), EUR



Same budget, €305k moved: incremental orders over 12 months



Recommendations

1 · Budget on 12-month net value, not last-click orders: trim PPC non-brand by 20% and fund creators.
2 · Coupon sites: no commission when the cart was already started; one code per creator, revoked when it leaks.
3 · Brand ads: keep them only where competitors bid on the brand name.

Next quarter's test plan

Geo holdout on creators (2 countries, 8 weeks) to replace the halo estimate with a measured lift; brand-ad test by country with competitor-bid monitoring; refund-rate alert per partner.

SIMULATED data (seed 42), calibrated on public hostinger.com prices, refund and affiliate terms (data/SOURCES.md) - not Hostinger data · DiD = difference-in-differences, bootstrap 5,000 resamples of weeks · Independent case study for Hostinger's Marketing and Product Data Analyst roles · Not affiliated with Hostinger, no Hostinger data

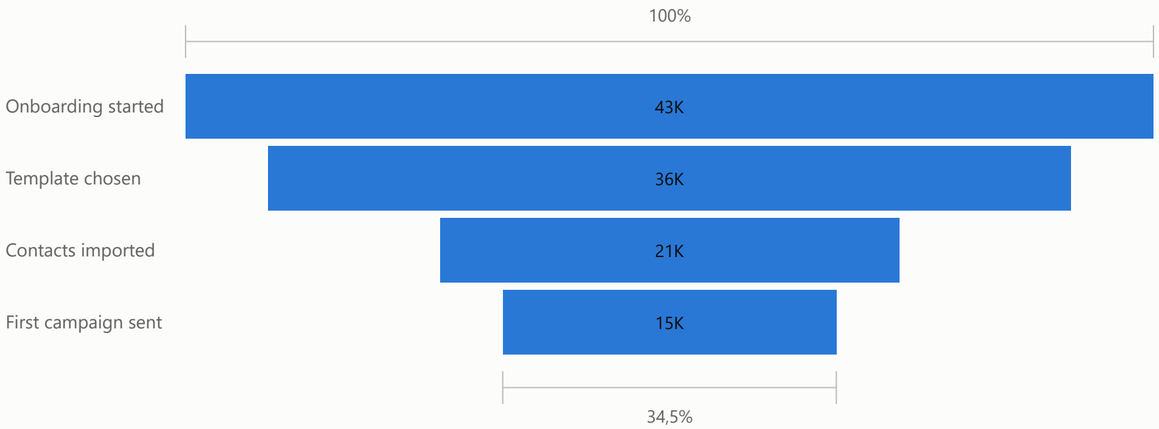
43% of Reach users who pick a template never import contacts: the biggest leak in onboarding

SIMULATED DATA

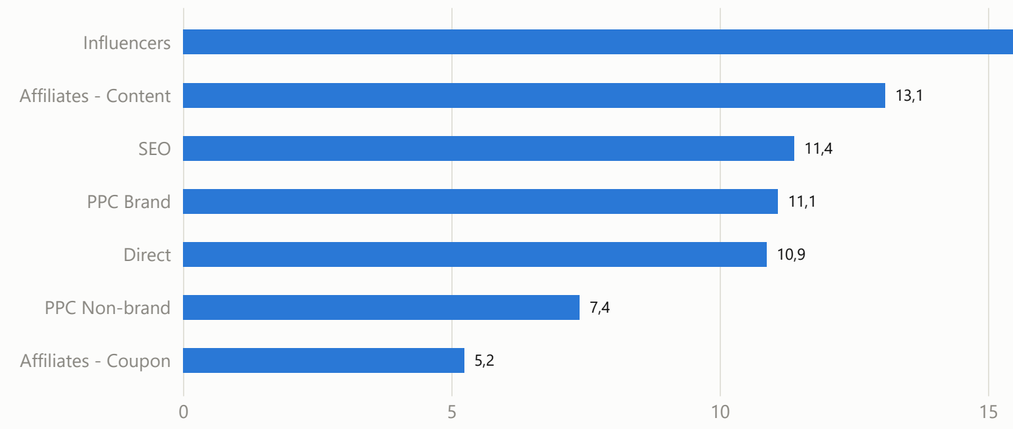
Of 43,277 users who started Hostinger Reach onboarding (30-day window over), 83% chose a template, 47% imported contacts and 34% sent a first campaign; contact import loses 15,366 users, more in India and Indonesia. Marketing link: per 100 new customers, creators bring 17 users who reach the aha moment, PPC non-brand 7, coupon sites 5.

Started onboarding (30-day window over)	Chose a template	Imported contacts	Sent a first campaign (30 days)	First campaign within 7 days
43K	83%	47%	34%	24,2%

Ordered funnel, 30-day conversion window (users at each step)



Per 100 new customers of each acquisition channel: users who send a first Reach campaign within 7 days



Step by step: conversion from the previous step and median time it takes

Step	Users	From previous step	Users lost	Median hours from previous
Onboarding started	43 277	100%		
Template chosen	35 895	83%	7 382	6
Contacts imported	20 529	57%	15 366	17
First campaign sent	14 914	73%	5 615	74

Funnel by country (red = weaker contact import)

Country	Starters	Template	Contacts	First campaign	Within 7 days
Spain	4 231	83%	51%	36%	25,2%
United States	11 582	83%	50%	36%	25,1%
France	5 757	82%	49%	36%	25,7%
Brazil	6 613	83%	49%	35%	24,7%
Indonesia	6 343	83%	44%	32%	22,5%
India	8 751	83%	43%	32%	22,5%

Adoption = first campaign within 7 days: 63% still active at day 30, vs 41% for later senders

SIMULATED DATA

Day-30 retention is flat for a first campaign on day 0-1, 2-3 or 4-7 and falls after day 7, so adoption is defined there; 24% of starters reach it. The 44-point gap holds in every channel, platform and product, but it is a correlation (motivated users are faster and more loyal): an encouragement test would measure the causal part. Hostinger Mail: AI replies lift messages sent by +10% for mobile users only.

Adopted: first campaign within 7 days

24,2%

Active at day 30, all starters

30%

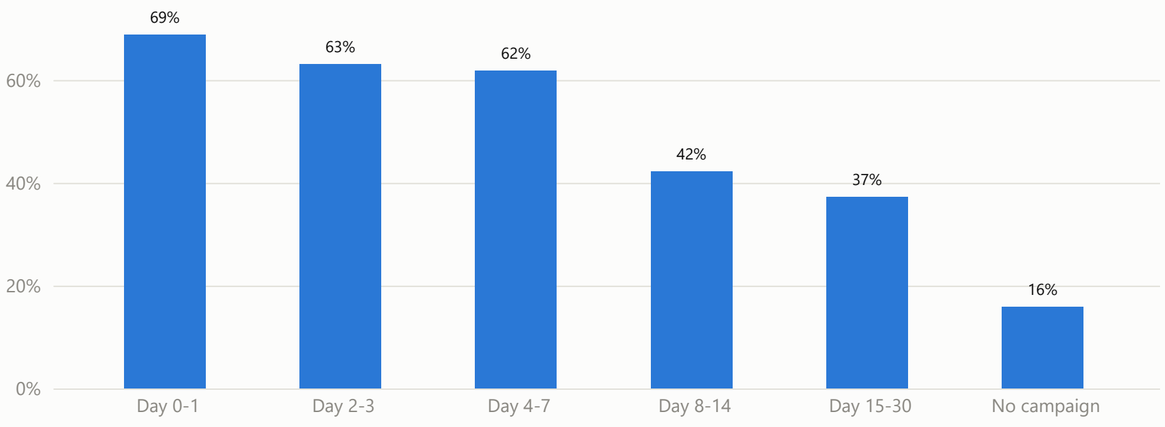
Active at day 30, adopters

63%

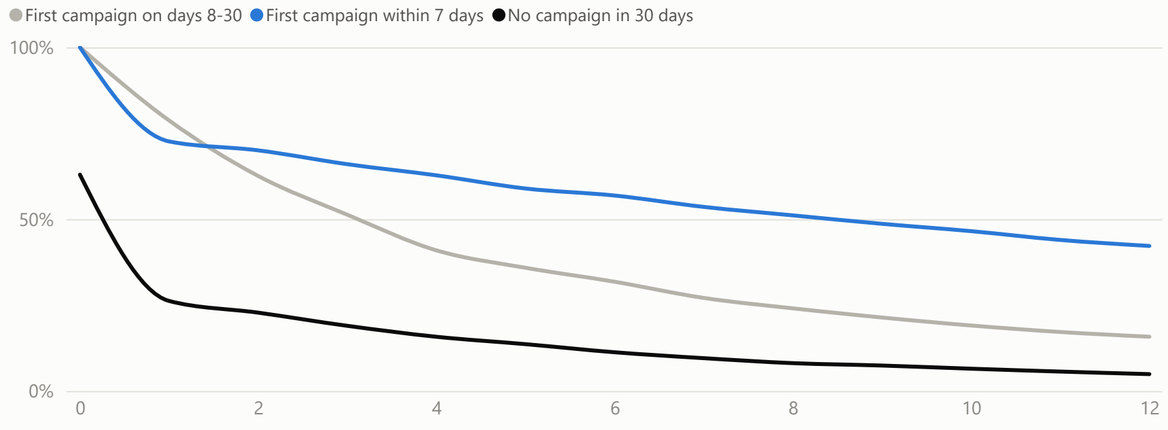
Upgraded within 60 days

9,3%

Day-30 retention by the day of the first campaign (users with 35 days of history)



Share of users active each week after the start, by adoption group (censoring-safe)



Proposed definition of a successful Reach adoption

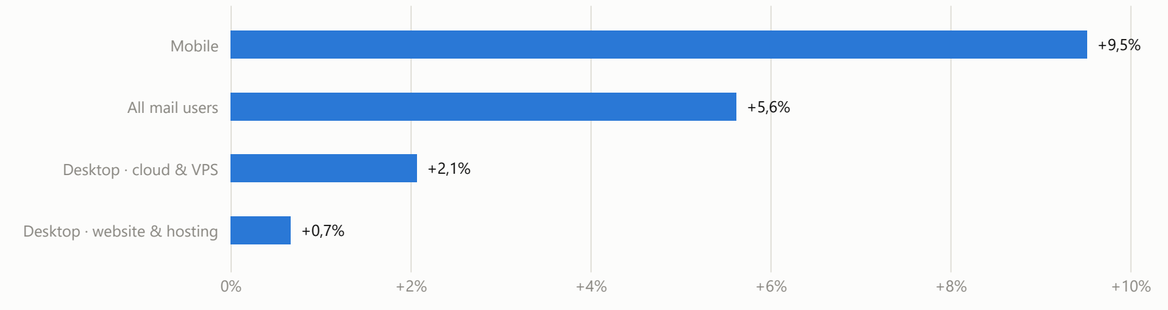
Leading, week 1 first campaign within 7 days of the start: predicts retention, early enough to act on, moved by onboarding.

Habit, week 5 a core action in days 28-34 (campaign, AI copy, template, contacts).

Value, month 2 upgrade to a paid plan within 60 days (the free Starter plan stops at 100 recipients).

Proving causality randomise a strong push to the first campaign (contacts-import assistant + day-2 reminder) and compare retention by assigned group (intention to treat).

Hostinger Mail: change in messages sent per user after AI replies (wave 1 vs wave 2, difference-in-differences)



SIMULATED product events (seed 42), same simulated customers, calibrated on public hostinger.com terms (data/SOURCES.md) - not Hostinger data · sql/09, product notebook §2-3 · Independent case study for Hostinger's Marketing and Product Data Analyst roles · Not affiliated with Hostinger, no Hostinger data

AI-prefilled first campaign: +2.5 pts of 7-day activation once a broken test day is removed

SIMULATED DATA

Plan fixed before launch: primary metric first campaign within 7 days, 16 weeks, minimum detectable effect 2.7 pts. The sample-ratio check failed (p < 0.001): on 14 July every mobile user went to control. Without that day (p = 0.66) activation rises from 25.3% to 27.8% (95% CI +0.7 to +4.4 pts, p = 0.008); keeping it would have reported +3.3 pts. Upgrades dip 1.3 pts (p = 0.12 after correction): ship with a holdout.

Users in the test (14 July removed)	Control: blank editor	Treatment: AI-prefilled campaign	Effect, points
8 667	25,3%	27,8%	+2,5%

Users assigned per day: on 14 July (newsletter day) every mobile user went to control



Test plan, written before launch

Hypothesis an AI draft removes the blank page, so more users send a first campaign.
Primary first campaign within 7 days. **Guardrails** day-30 retention, upgrades in 60 days.
Power 4,074 users per arm in 16 weeks: 2.7 pts detectable at 80% power.
Rules sample-ratio check first; one reading at the end, no peeking; segments exploratory (Holm).

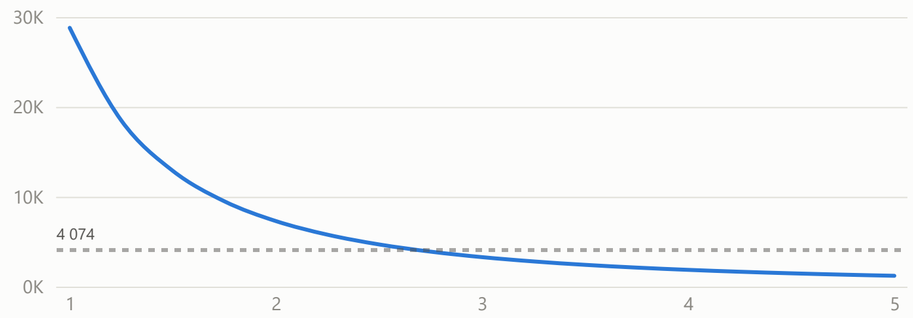
Decision

Ship to all new Reach users, keep a 5% holdout for 8 weeks to confirm the effect and watch upgrades and novelty (weeks 1-8 vs 9-16: interaction p ≥ 0.18). Add a daily automatic SRM alert.

Results on the clean sample (95% CI; p_holm = corrected for the 4 secondary metrics)

Metric	Control	Treatment	Effect	CI low	CI high	p	p (Holm)
First campaign within 7 days (primary)	25,3%	27,8%	+2,5%	+0,7%	+4,4%	0,008	0,008
Template chosen	83,2%	86,0%	+2,9%	+1,3%	+4,4%	0,000	0,001
Contacts imported	49,2%	49,4%	+0,2%	-1,9%	+2,3%	0,877	1,000
Day-30 retention (guardrail)	30,2%	30,2%	-0,0%	-1,9%	+1,9%	0,988	1,000
Upgrade within 60 days (guardrail)	10,5%	9,2%	-1,3%	-2,6%	-0,1%	0,040	0,121

Users per arm needed vs effect to detect, in points (dashed = 16 weeks of traffic)



SIMULATED product events (seed 42), same simulated customers, calibrated on public hostinger.com terms (data/SOURCES.md) - not Hostinger data · sql/10, product notebook §1 · Independent case study for Hostinger's Marketing and Product Data Analyst roles · Not affiliated with Hostinger, no Hostinger data

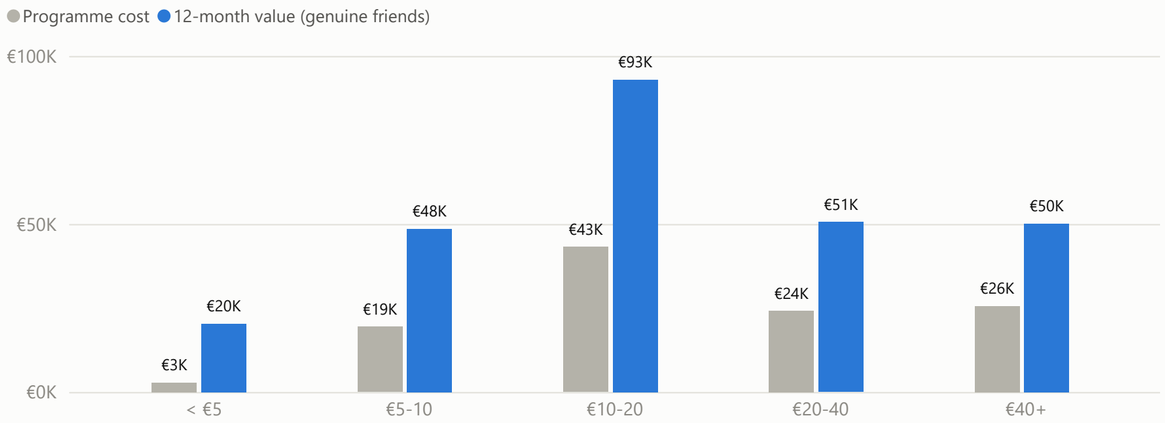
Self-referrals take 11% of the referral budget: block them before touching the reward rate

SIMULATED DATA

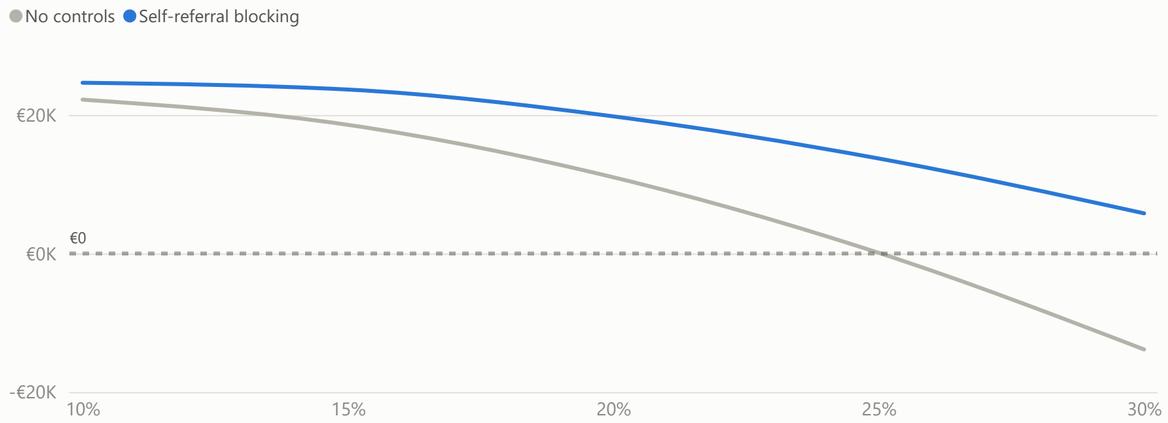
3,620 referrals cost €115k: 20% reward to the referrer plus the friend's 20% discount (public terms). It pays back only if 44% of referred friends would not have bought otherwise. 431 referrals (11.9%) look like customers referring a second account (same card, or same device and sign-up 2 minutes after the link). Scenario (labelled assumptions): blocking them adds €9k a year; the best reward rate needs a reward test.

Referrals, May 2025 - Oct 2026	Rewards + friend discounts	Friends who must be truly new	Flagged as self-referrals
3 620	€115K	44%	11,9%

By reward size: programme cost (grey) vs 12-month value of genuine friends (blue), EUR



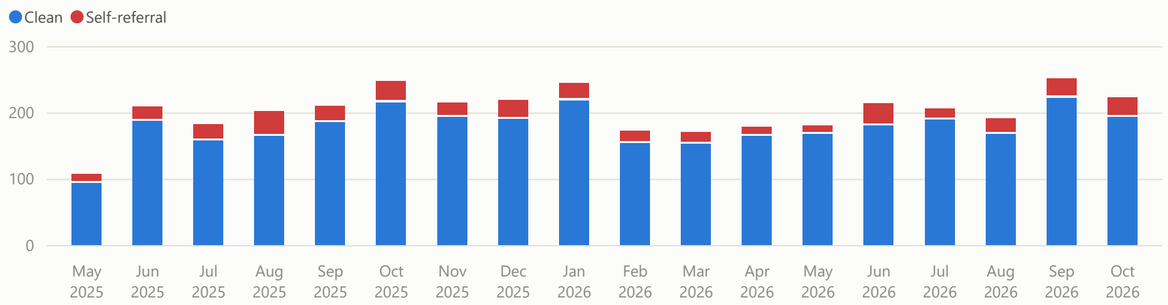
Scenario: net value per year by reward rate (assumed: 50% of friends truly new, elasticity 0.5)



Self-referral checks: what each rule catches

Check	Referrals	Rewards	Rewards + discounts	Median minutes link → sign-up
Clean	3 092	€42 576	€98 849	205 572
Block: same payment card	356	€4 481	€10 310	2
Review: same device	97	€1 473	€3 393	185 932
Block: same device, sign-up < 10 min	75	€1 084	€2 549	2

Referrals per month: clean (blue) and flagged self-referrals (red)



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One star schema for both parts: shared Date, Channel and Country dimensions

ANNEX

Annex. The Power BI model is written as code (src/build_tmdl.py, TMDL) and the pages as PBIR (src/build_report_pages.py). Facts read the CSV outputs of the SQL files and notebooks; small output tables feed single charts. The shared dimensions let a product metric be cut by the acquisition channel of the customer.

Fact tables

Marketing

Orders one row per order: paid, refunded, renewals, 30-day / 12-month value
Attribution Credits order × model × channel credit (6 models)
Spend day × channel × campaign

Product

Reach Users one row per Reach user: funnel steps, aha moment, retention, upgrade
Experiment Users one row per user in the A/B test, with every test metric
Referrals one row per referral: reward, discount, friend's value, fraud checks
Product Daily 2.3M Amplitude-style events rolled up by day, event, platform, country

Dimensions

Shared by both parts

Date 1 May 2024 - 31 Oct 2026, month sort key
Channel 8 acquisition channels + Unattributed, grouped
Country 6 countries, geo-test group

Marketing

Attribution Model, Creator, Affiliate

Product

Product Reach, Mail, Referral
AB Variant control, treatment

Modelling rules

Single-direction relationships, dimension → fact, no many-to-many.
Censoring-safe rates: a user counts only once the window is over (funnel_complete, mature_d30, ...).
Test data A/B measures exclude 14 July, the day of the sample-ratio mismatch.
Measures 77 DAX measures in display folders; product measures under Product\Funnel, Adoption, A/B test, Referral.
Numbers in titles are read from the SQL and notebook outputs by the page script, never typed by hand.

Relationships (27), fact → dimensions

Orders → Date, Country
Attribution Credits → Orders, Channel, Attribution Model
Spend → Date, Channel, Country, Creator, Affiliate
Code Usage → Creator
Value Curve → Channel
Channel Quality → Channel
Incremental Cost → Channel
Reach Users → Date, Country, Channel
Experiment Users → AB Variant, Date, Country
Referrals → Date, Country, Channel
Product Daily → Date, Product, Country
Reach Adoption by Channel → Channel